

Instagram Graph API Permissions

Complete feature breakdown with simple examples for each permission

1. instagram_business_basic

Access basic Instagram business account information — profile details, media list, and account stats.

1.1 Show account profile

Fetch and display the connected account's username, display name, profile picture, and bio inside your app.

Example: Your app shows a card: '@bakerycorner — 12.3k followers' with their profile photo, pulled straight from Instagram.

1.2 Display follower / following / media counts

Pull the total number of followers, accounts followed, and total posts published.

Example: A dashboard widget shows: Followers: 12,340 | Following: 210 | Posts: 87.

1.3 List all posts (photos, videos, reels, carousels)

Retrieve every post on the account along with captions, media URLs, media type, and post timestamp.

Example: Your app displays a grid of the last 20 Instagram posts inside a 'My Content' tab, just like the Instagram profile grid.

1.4 Get details of a single post

Fetch full details of one specific post — like count, comment count, direct permalink URL.

Example: User clicks a post in your app and sees: '245 likes, 12 comments' with a 'View on Instagram' link.

1.5 Connect/link Instagram account (login flow)

Let users authorize and link their Instagram Business account to your app via OAuth.

Example: A 'Connect Instagram' button on your app's settings page starts the login flow and links their account.

1.6 Manage multiple Instagram accounts

Since basic access works per authorized account, your app can store and switch between several linked accounts.

Example: An agency dashboard shows a dropdown: 'Client A - Coffee Shop' / 'Client B - Gym', switching data per account.

2. instagram_business_manage_comments

Read, reply to, hide, or delete comments on your Instagram posts.

2.1 Display all comments on a post

Fetch and list every comment (and replies) left on a specific post inside your own app interface.

Example: Your app shows a comment feed under each post: 'John: Love this!', 'Priya: Where is this shop?'.

2.2 Reply to comments

Send a reply to any comment programmatically, without opening the Instagram app.

Example: A customer comments 'Do you deliver?' and your app auto-posts a reply: 'Yes! DM us your address.'

2.3 Delete unwanted/spam comments

Remove abusive, spammy, or irrelevant comments directly through the API.

Example: Your app auto-deletes any comment containing a banned word list like 'scam' or spam links.

2.4 Hide/unhide comments

Hide a comment from public view without fully deleting it (reversible).

Example: A slightly negative comment gets hidden automatically until a manager reviews and decides to unhide it.

2.5 Keyword-based auto-reply

Detect specific keywords in comments and trigger an automatic reply.

Example: Someone comments 'PRICE' on a product photo — your app instantly replies with the price list link.

2.6 Moderation dashboard (multi-post / multi-account)

Build a central screen showing comments across many posts (or many client accounts) for review and action.

Example: A social media manager sees all new comments from 5 client accounts in one table and replies from there.

2.7 Comment-to-DM automation

When a user comments a trigger word, automatically send them a private DM (commonly used for lead generation).

Example: User comments 'INFO' on an ad post → your app auto-sends them a DM with a discount code or catalog link.

3. instagram_business_manage_messages

Access, read, and send Instagram Direct Messages (DMs) on behalf of the business account.

3.1 View Instagram DM inbox in-app

Pull all incoming direct messages into your own app's inbox screen instead of the Instagram app.

Example: Your support dashboard lists new DMs: 'Sarah: Is this in stock?' right next to your email inbox.

3.2 Send messages to users

Reply to a user who has messaged you first (Instagram requires the user to message first, per policy).

Example: Support agent types a reply in your app, and it's sent as an Instagram DM to the customer instantly.

3.3 Build a chatbot for FAQs / support / leads

Automatically respond to common questions using pre-set logic or AI, without a human typing every reply.

Example: User DMs 'store hours?' → bot instantly replies: 'We're open 10 AM–9 PM, Mon–Sat.'

3.4 Send quick replies / buttons / templates

Send structured messages with tappable buttons instead of plain text, guiding the user's next step.

Example: Bot sends: 'What do you need help with?' with buttons [Order Status] [Pricing] [Talk to Human].

3.5 Auto-respond to first-time messages (welcome message)

Send an automatic greeting the moment a new user messages your account for the first time.

Example: First-time DM triggers: 'Hey! Thanks for reaching out to XYZ Store. How can we help?'

3.6 Route DMs to human agents (helpdesk-style)

Assign incoming conversations to specific team members inside your app when the bot can't handle it.

Example: A complex complaint DM gets auto-assigned to 'Agent: Riya' in your internal support tool.

3.7 Send order/booking updates via DM

Proactively message users (who've messaged before) with transactional updates.

Example: 'Your order #1234 has shipped and will arrive by Friday!' sent automatically as a DM.

4. instagram_business_manage_insights

Access analytics and performance data for the account, posts, and stories.

4.1 Account-level insights: Reach

See how many unique accounts saw any of your content in a given period.

Example: Dashboard shows: 'Reach this week: 8,500 unique accounts.'

4.1 Account-level insights: Impressions

See the total number of times your content was displayed (including repeat views by the same person).

Example: Dashboard shows: 'Impressions this week: 15,200 total views.'

4.1 Account-level insights: Profile views

See how many times people visited your Instagram profile page.

Example: Dashboard shows: 'Profile views: 1,240 this month' — helps you gauge curiosity vs. actual engagement.

4.1 Account-level insights: Website clicks

See how many people tapped the website link in your bio.

Example: Dashboard shows: 'Website clicks: 320' — useful for measuring traffic driven from Instagram to your site.

4.2 Post-level insights

Get performance data for one specific post: likes, comments, saves, shares, and reach for that post.

Example: Under a product photo: 'Likes: 340 | Comments: 22 | Saves: 58 | Shares: 14 | Reach: 4,100.'

4.3 Story insights

Track how individual Stories perform: views, exits, replies, and forward/back taps.

Example: A Story insight shows: 'Views: 900 | Exits: 45 | Replies: 12 | Tapped forward: 300.'

4.4 Audience demographics

See breakdowns of your followers by age range, gender, top locations, and most active hours (where Instagram provides this data).

Example: Chart shows: '35% aged 18–24, 60% female, top city: Mumbai, most active 7–9 PM.'

4.5 Analytics dashboards / weekly-monthly reports

Combine account, post, and story insights into a single visual report over time.

Example: Your app generates a 'Weekly Performance Report' every Monday showing growth trends in a chart.

4.6 Compare performance across posts or accounts

Show side-by-side metrics to identify what content or which account is performing best.

Example: A table compares 5 recent posts: Post A got the most saves, Post C got the most reach.

4.7 Export insights as PDF/CSV reports

Generate downloadable reports for clients or internal review.

Example: Agency clicks 'Export Report' and downloads a PDF summarizing their account's monthly performance.

5. Combined Application Ideas (using all 4 permissions together)

- **Social media management tool** — A Buffer/Hootsuite-style app to view posts, manage comments, reply to DMs, and see analytics — all in one dashboard.
- **Instagram CRM** — Track every customer's comments, DM history, and engagement in one profile, like a mini customer database.
- **Automated customer support system** — Chatbot handles FAQs via DM, escalates tricky questions to a human agent, and logs everything.
- **Marketing agency dashboard** — Manage 10+ client Instagram accounts — content, comments, DMs, and reports — from a single login.
- **Analytics/reporting SaaS** — A subscription tool that sends influencers or brands a weekly Instagram performance report automatically.
- **Comment-to-DM lead generation tool** — Someone comments a keyword on your ad post, and the tool auto-DMs them a lead magnet or discount code.

Important Limits to Know:

1. These 4 permissions do **not** include posting/publishing content — that needs the separate `instagram_content_publish` permission.
2. Only works with an Instagram **Business or Creator** account linked to a Facebook Page.
3. For DMs: Instagram policy generally requires the **user to message first** before your app can reply (within a 24-hour messaging window, with some exceptions).

4. To use these on accounts other than your own test/developer account, your app needs **Meta App Review approval**.